



MoE's
INNOVATION CELL
(GOVERNMENT OF INDIA)



SMART INDIA
HACKATHON
2026

SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

GUIDELINES

#InnovationseAtmaNirbharBharat

STUDENT/TEAM FORMATION

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All team members must be from the same college (no inter-college teams)

Each team consists of 6 members, including the team leader.

At least one female team member is mandatory

For software edition, programming skills are crucial. For hardware edition, multi-disciplinary teams are encouraged (Mechanical Engineers, Electronic Engineers, Product Designers, Programmers, etc.)

STUDENT REGISTRATION CRITERIA

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**ONLY STUDENTS
SELECTED IN THE
INTERNAL
HACKATHON CAN BE
REGISTERED FOR THE
SMART INDIA
HACKATHON 2026**

**THE COLLEGE SPOC
NOMINATES TOP
TEAMS BASED ON
INTERNAL
HACKATHON
RESULTS.**

**MAXIMUM 50 (45
SHORTLISTED + 5
WAITLISTED)
TEAMS CAN
PARTICIPATE IN
SMART INDIA
HACKATHON 2026
FROM INSTITUTE**

NOTE: UNIVERSITY CAN NOMINATE UPTO 100 TEAMS

SIH 2026

TEAM NOMINATION PROCESS



- It is mandatory that the College SPOC enters the details for a nominated team in the prescribed format only (Annexure A, also can be downloaded from the SPOC dashboard). Team details once entered cannot be altered. College SPOC will be responsible to ensure that all the data entered by him/ her is accurate

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- The letter must be issued on college letterhead only. It must clearly state name of the team and all 6 team members and upto 2 Faculty/Industry Mentor and must be duly signed by college principal/ dean/ institute director and bear the college seal. This letter will be required during the grand finale, if the team is selected for grand finale

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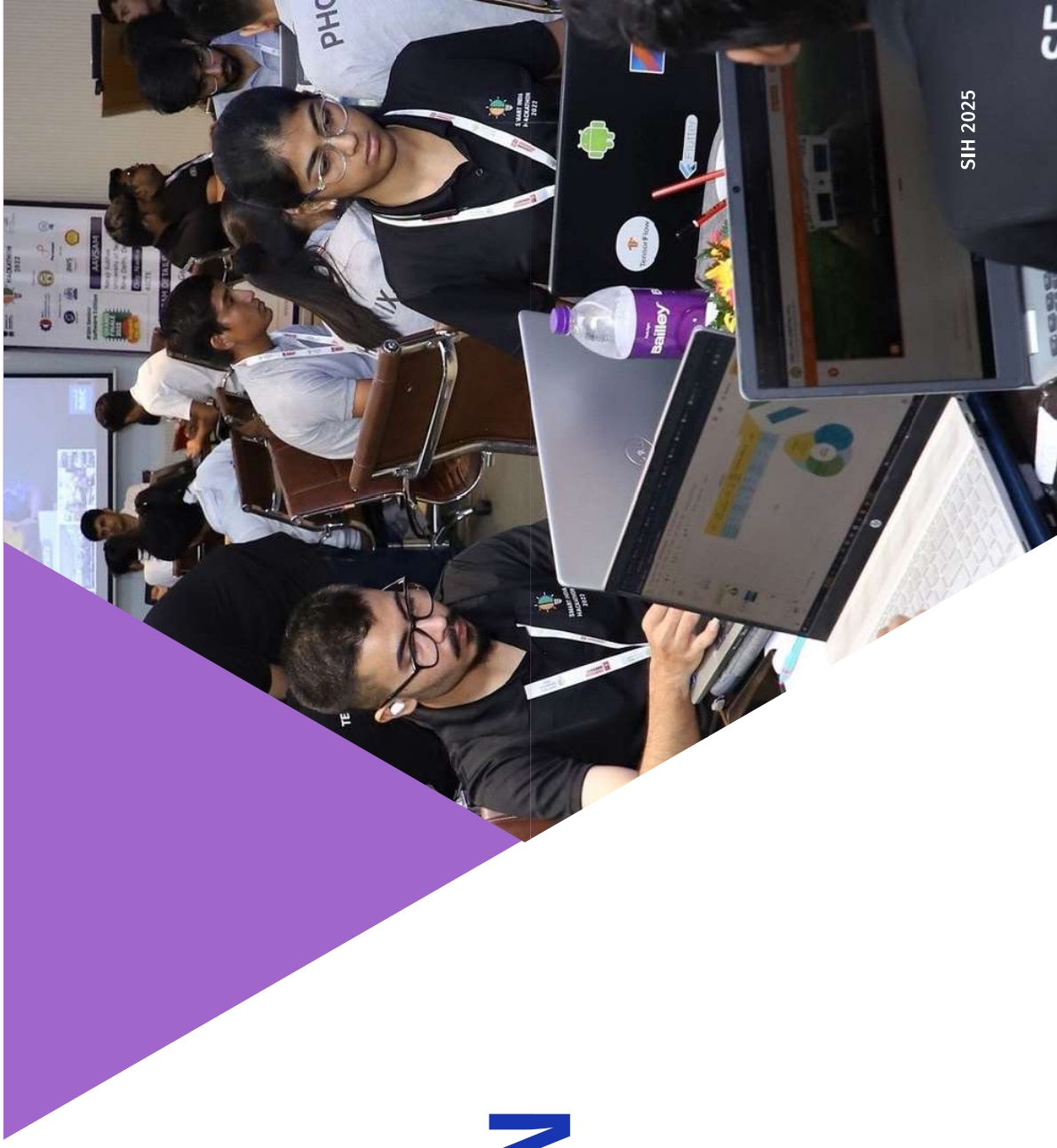
- The team name should be unique and must not contain the name of your institute in any form
- A max of 50 teams (45 Shortlisted + 05 Waitlisted) per college and in case of university 100 Team can be nominated (including Problem statement based/Student innovation category)

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- There is no bar for the Software and hardware categories. You can make the combination as per your convenience but the total number of the teams should not breach 50 team's criteria for institute and 100 for university.

TEAM NOMINATION PROCESS

IDEA SUBMISSION PROCESS



IDEA SUBMISSION PROCESS

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- SPOC registration will start from July 2026 & **the last date for team nomination and idea submission by College SPOC on SIH portal is till 15th Sep 2026.**
- Idea submission counter will start from Aug 2026 and only 500 ideas will be submitted for a particular PS. Once the count number got all 500 ideas, the particular PS will get freeze and no idea submission will be allowed for the respective PS
- Count number with the ideas submitted numbers and Ideas left numbers will be displayed in the public domain just opposite to the PS and can be viewed by anyone on sih.gov.in
One team can submit Ideas against maximum of 2 Problem Statement only
- Nominated Team's team leader will get the Login credentials after SPOC upload team details in the portal to complete the idea submission process
- The last date for team nomination and idea submission by College SPOC and Team leader on SIH portal is till 15th Sept 2026 only. No request will be entertained after the deadline

SIH 2026

IDEA SUBMISSION PROCESS

The team leader needs to enter the details on the SIH portal that include:

- 1) Verify pre-entered Team name.
- 2) Verify pre-entered College authorization letter PDF (in given format)
- 3) Verify pre-entered Names of team leader and the rest 5 team members
- 4) Verify pre-entered Gender of team leader and the rest 5 team members
- 5) Verify pre-entered Email id of all the team members along with the team leader
- 6) Verify pre-entered Mobile no. of all the team members along with the team leader
- 7) Chosen problem statement or Student Innovation Category.
- 8) Idea title.
- 9) Idea description.
- 10) Idea presentation (PDF).

SHORTLISTED IDEAS ANNOUNCEMENT

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Notification about selected teams will be put up on our portal and will also be sent to their respective email IDs



Be available for meetings, sessions and trainings during the preparation phase; you will be notified about them in advance



4-5 teams per problem statement may be selected for the grand finale, but the final decision rests with the problem statement creating organization, which isn't obligated to declare a winner unless student proposals meet their expectations